Begum Rokeya University, Rangpur • Department of Management Information Systems

INTERNSHIP REPORT

Evaluating MIS Practices in Project Monitoring

A Study on RDRS Bangladesh

Submitted By / Submitted To / Host

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In collaboration with **RDRS Bangladesh, MEL Department**

Internship at RDRS Bangladesh • Fieldwork: Rangpur • September–November 2026

Date of Submission: _____ Place: Rangpur

Sources: MEL monitoring schedule • G Banker outputs • C-RANGPUR instrument & F01-112 matrix • KII & field notes • RDRS Annual Report & Strategic Plan • Somriddhi report • Policy docs

Letter of Transmittal

[Date]

Mohammad Rakibul Islam Bhuiyan
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Subject: Submission of Internship Report on "Evaluating MIS Practices in Project Monitoring: A Study on RDRS Bangladesh"

Dear Sir,

I am pleased to submit my internship report, prepared as a partial requirement for the BBA program, based on my internship at the MEL Department of RDRS Bangladesh. The report examines the MIS practices used in project monitoring, drawing on direct observation, discussions with staff, and review of ongoing projects during the internship period.

I tried to keep the report within the scope of my access and the time available, and I would be grateful for your guidance on further revisions. Thank you for your continuous support and supervision.

Sincerely,
A. R. Mahmud ID: 12022065
BBA, Major in MIS

Acknowledgement

I thank my academic supervisor for guidance on structure and scope, and the RDRS MEL Department staff who gave their time: Md. Saiful Alam (Shekul) for a long walk-through of baseline design, Fahmida Mostafa for explaining projects and reporting flow, and Mr. Iftekharul Islam for tracing the microfinance MIS history. Any errors in interpretation are mine.

Executive Summary

Guiding question: how does monitoring data actually move from the field to a management decision at RDRS Bangladesh, and where does the system help or break?

I spent the internship inside the MEL Department. For routine work the team runs on structured Excel formats and registers; for one-off needs it uses KoBo Toolbox on mobile with direct Excel export; in office it compiles in Excel and builds some dashboards in Power BI. G Banker carries microfinance reporting. A monthly monitoring schedule turns this into named assignments. The issue I reviewed splits into ten repeat microfinance tasks (each branch twice a month) and project-specific development tasks, including the live ICPS baseline (UNICEF, 06–24 Sept, Saiful Alam Sekul and Fahmida Mostafa) and the C-RANGPUR baseline across six districts.

Two strands carry the findings. Microfinance has moved from a person-dependent process (Micro Bank, 1995–97, 27 developers) through South Tech (2011) to G Banker (2017/18), where the CO-wise Changes Report, POMIS-5 and POMIS-4 now come out with one click into an integrated dashboard. That succession is the continuity lesson: documenting definitions (OTR, PAR, write-off) and keeping two owners per report family matters. Programme work runs on a different stack. C-RANGPUR shows it most clearly: a ten-section KoBo questionnaire (Sections 5–9 map to Indicators 1.1–3.2, Section 10 is the 16-item vulnerability module), seven indicators with explicit numerator/denominator formulas, a MEL matrix file F01-112, and a Household Climate Vulnerability Index scored 30/30/40 as $\text{HCVI} = 0.30\text{EI} + 0.30\text{SI} + 0.40(100 - \text{ACI})$. KoBo auto-submits, passes verification, then feeds HCVI and IGA calculation across KoBo, Excel and Power BI. The project MIS stays separate from G Banker. No integration.

Gaps sit at the last mile. In the May 2023 Somriddhi report (Panchagarh and Kurigram, PKSF, 2 of 3 unions) MIS attendance read 100% against 89% in registers, 65% of rehabilitation income records could not be found, and similar MIS-vs-field mismatches recur.

Turnover (11 of 74 centres in four months) and low tree survival (35% vs. 49%) signal thin follow-up. Special monitoring still needs a person on site for overdue reasons, high-value PAR/OTR tracking and document checks. Credit Shield (Guardian Life, since July 2024, BDT 6 per 1,000, BDT 15,000 cash plus waiver up to BDT 20 lakh) moves on paper and signatures. The C-RANGPUR instrument itself carries small label and code slips and the HCVI calculation is spread across three tools, not one pipeline. Housing and some income gains were real, but the register-to-system check was missing.

Recommendations: (1) add a register-to-MIS reconciliation sign-off to the monthly schedule before any report is locked; (2) keep KoBo as single capture for ad-hoc surveys so Excel is compilation-only; (3) document G Banker definitions and keep two trained owners per report family for continuity. If only one is done, do (1).

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Abbreviations: MEL – Monitoring, Evaluation and Learning; MEAL – plus Accountability; ESS – Environmental and Social Safeguard; TOR – Terms of Reference; FGD – Focus Group Discussion; KII – Key Informant Interview; HH – Household; IGA – Income Generating Activity; CSA – Climate Smart Agriculture; HCVI – Household Climate Vulnerability Index (EI – Exposure Index; SI – Sensitivity Index; ACI – Adaptive Capacity Index); NCD – Non-Communicable Disease; SPSS – Statistical Package for the Social Sciences; PKSF – Palli Karma-Sahayak Foundation; CO – Credit Organizer; OTR – On-Time Repayment; PAR – Portfolio at Risk; DQA – Data Quality Assessment; ATM – Assistant Thana Manager (historic); MSDS – Monthly Savings Deposit Scheme; WASH – Water, Sanitation and Hygiene; LRL – Livelihood Restoration Loan; BFIU – Bangladesh Financial Intelligence Unit; A2J – Access to Justice for Women; GIZ – Deutsche Gesellschaft für Internationale Zusammenarbeit; ADR – Alternative Dispute Resolution; DLAO – District Legal Aid Officer / Office; DLAC / UZLAC / UPLAC – District / Upazila / Union Parishad Legal Aid Committee; LSID – Legal Service Information Desk; PNGO – Partner Non-Governmental Organization; CDR – Community Dispute Resolution; GRO – General Register Officer (Court Police); ATT / CT / AHTT / ST – Anti-Terrorism / Cyber / Anti-Human Trafficking / Special Tribunal; CrPC – Code of Criminal Procedure; DBLA – District Bar Legal Aid.

CHAPTER 1

Introduction

1.1 Background of the Study

Internship reports matter for BBA/MIS students because classroom models of systems rarely survive contact with registers, branch visits, and monthly deadlines. I interned with the MEL Department of RDRS Bangladesh to see how a large NGO actually tracks project progress: who reports, on which form or app, who checks it, and where it is stored.

1.2 Objectives of the Study

Broad objective. To evaluate the MIS practices used in project monitoring at RDRS Bangladesh.

Specific objectives.

1. To identify the MIS tools and systems used by the MEL Department.
2. To examine how monitoring data flows from the field to decision-making.
3. To assess strengths and gaps in current MIS practices.
4. To recommend improvements based on findings.

1.3 Scope of the Study

The report covers the MEL Department during the internship period and the projects I had access to: Jononni, SEEDS, MCGL, ICPS, the microfinance programme, and the Somriddhi monitoring report. It does not cover the full RDRS portfolio or audited financials.

1.4 Methodology

1.4.1 Sources of data

Primary data came from four interviews and direct observation. I spoke with Md. Saiful Alam (Shekul), now on the ICPS baseline team and formerly Technical Specialist, MEAL and GIS on the BHA project with Save the Children in Sylhet, for close to two hours on MEL work and baseline design. I spoke with Fahmida Mostafa, Senior MEL Officer, on active projects, MEL workflow, programme areas and field scale. I spoke with Mr. Iftekharul Islam, Manager, Monitoring, on how microfinance MIS changed from manual work to the current system. I additionally conducted a key informant interview with Md. Ajazul Haque, Manager (MEL), on the C-RANGPUR baseline instrument, indicator measurement, and the KoBo-to-dashboard data pipeline (see Table 1.1; interview date to be inserted from field notes).

Secondary data came from handwritten notes and the supporting documents I reviewed: the MEL Department September 2026 monitoring schedule, sample MIS outputs from G Banker (CO-wise Changes Report, POMIS-5, POMIS-4), the Strategic Plan 2023–2027, the May 2023 field monitoring report on the Somriddhi Programme funded by PKSF, and, for C-RANGPUR, the baseline household questionnaire for indicator result measurement (MEL Department), the project monitoring matrix file F01-112 ("Monitoring Planning" tab), and undated internal planning-meeting notes on the MEL matrix and baseline design.

1.4.2 Data collection method

I collected data through informal interviews, sitting in on explanations of forms and dashboards, and reviewing registers, schedules and reports. A field visit including an eye clinic is planned as direct observation of MEL data collection. The C-RANGPUR key informant interview used a short structured set of MIS questions (automation of the vulnerability calculation, purpose of the code column, submission-to-dashboard flow, baseline-to-target comparison, and separation from the microfinance MIS), with answers recorded as summarised in Chapter 4. Broader discussion in that interview on research methodology is noted separately and kept out of the MIS findings.

Table 1.1. Interviews conducted

Name	Role	Focus
Md. Saiful Alam (Shekul)	ICPS baseline team; ex-MEAL & GIS, BHA/Save the Children	MEL functions; baseline design; indicators, ESS, TOR, Inception Report (~2 hrs)
Fahmida Mostafa	Senior MEL Officer	Active projects; MEL workflow; five programme areas; field scale
Mr. Iftekharul Islam	Manager, Monitoring	Microfinance MIS history: manual to automated
Md. Ajazul Haque	Manager (MEL)	C-RANGPUR MIS pipeline; KoBo instrument; indicator and HCVI measurement (KII; date to confirm)

1.5 Limitations of the Study

Time was short, access to some branch-level data was restricted, and the scope is a single department. Figures move year to year, so I cite the source and date for each number.

CHAPTER 2

Organizational Overview

2.1 About RDRS Bangladesh

RDRS started in Rangpur in February 1972 as the Bangladesh field programme of the Lutheran World Federation (Department for World Service, Geneva). The first job was relief for war-affected people in the northwest: food, shelter, medical help, seeds and tools. The name moved from Rangpur Dinajpur Relief Service to Rangpur Dinajpur Rural Service; it is now RDRS Bangladesh.

The northwest was chosen deliberately: structural isolation, the seasonal hunger gap known locally as Monga, and flood and river erosion from the Teesta–Jamuna–Brahmaputra system. Work shifted in stages: emergency relief (1972–75); schools, health posts, farm advice and village groups (1976–89); handover to Bangladeshi leadership with Trust Act registration and its own Board in 1997; then livelihoods, microfinance, climate adaptation and Union Federations from 1998. RDRS marked 50 years in February 2022. Head Office is House 43, Road 10, Sector 6, Uttara, Dhaka 1230; Central Coordination Office is in Rangpur.

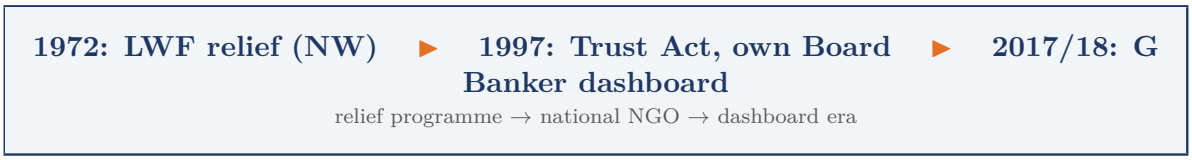


Figure 2.1. RDRS in three dates: from relief programme to national NGO to dashboard-era MIS.

2.2 Mission, Vision and Objectives

Vision (2021–22 annual report): A just and peaceful society where citizens live in dignity, free from poverty, distress, and ignorance in a sustainable environment.

Mission: RDRS works with disadvantaged and marginalized communities and their organizations to empower them, make them resilient, and ensure sustainable improvements in their lives with dignity. In practice this means rural poor households, especially women, higher incomes, stronger capacity against flood and drought, and community groups that continue without constant NGO support.

Core values (current): Compassion, Commitment, Innovation, Adaptability, Accountability. Staff still use older field words (social justice, gender equity, clean accounts), but I quote the five official ones. For monitoring this means every project must show who it reached and what changed — income, resilience, whether the local group can carry on. That is why registers, federation minutes and branch reports matter in Chapter 4.

2.3 Field Scale

Scale shared by MEL (Fahmida Mostafa)

406	33	183	872	~1.64m
Federations	Districts	Upazilas	Unions	People (16,42,724)

Most work is in Rangpur Division (Kurigram, Gaibandha, Thakurgaon, Dinajpur, Nilphamari, Panchagarh, Rangpur, Lalmonirhat), plus Ukhiya/Teknaf in Cox's Bazar and smaller work in Sylhet, Mymensingh and Rajshahi.

For reference, the 2021–22 annual report cited 7 divisions, 30 districts, 165 upazilas, 1,230 unions and 1,488,071 participants; the Dec 2024 microfinance sheet lists 29 districts, 288 branches, 21,134 groups, 458,819 members and 377,250 borrowers (savings BDT 5.14bn, outstanding BDT 15.09bn, recovery 95.08%).

2.4 Organizational Structure

A Board of Trustees governs RDRS with a General Body and senior management. Foreign-funded projects need NGO Affairs Bureau clearance (Foreign Donations Regulation Act 2016, FD6 forms, annual audited accounts). Lending falls under the Microcredit Regulatory Authority. Field work runs through regions, areas and branches (roughly 16–17 regions, 59–61 areas, 278–288 branches). The MEL Department cuts across all of it on monitoring and data. Union Federations are community-owned at Union Parishad level (406 federations; safety-net claims, dispute settlement, standing-committee seats).

2.5 The MEL Department

I was attached to the MEL Department. Field reports arrive here from groups, federations and branches; staff check, compile and send findings to management. What I tracked was simple: who reported, when, on which form or app, who checked it, where it is stored. A late report or vague indicator in the field becomes a gap in the monthly sheet. Chapter 4 follows that flow; notes here stay observational.

2.6 Overview of Ongoing Projects

RDRS groups work into five areas: (1) Skills, Employment and Entrepreneurship; (2) Social Empowerment; (3) Agriculture, Food Security and Climate Change; (4) Microfinance and Employment Creation; (5) Emergency and Humanitarian Response. Monitoring Officers cover all five.

The C-RANGPUR project (Climate Resilience And Nurturing Growth for Poverty Upliftment in Rangpur) sits in the agriculture, food security and climate change area and is handled by the MEL Department. Its stated Objective 1, as recorded in the monitoring matrix, is that the resilience of climate-affected households among the target group has been improved. The September 2026 monitoring schedule lists its baseline across Rangpur, Lalmonirhat, Kurigram, Sirajganj, Gaibandha and Jamalpur. The instrument, indicators and vulnerability methodology behind that baseline are examined in Chapter 4.

Table 2.1. Projects that came up repeatedly in interviews

Project	What it does	Donor / period
Jononni	Maternal/neonatal health; pregnant women	Save the Children, Mar 2023–Dec 2027 (Sept 2026 schedule)
SEEDS	Schooling for adolescents in adibashi communities; 3,000 families	Stromme Foundation, Jan 2024–Dec 2028
MCGL	Fewer preventable deaths; maternal/newborn/child health	U.S. Dept. of State via Jhpiego
ICPS	Disability-inclusive child protection (see Sec. 4.1.2)	UNICEF, Jun 2026–Dec 2027; BDT 2,20,40,834
C-RANGPUR	Climate resilience and poverty upliftment in Rangpur (see Sec. 4.1.3)	RDRS MEL Department; baseline Sept 2026 schedule
A2J for Women	Legal aid, court-annexed ADR/mediation, and formal case management across Courts, DLAO, Police Stations, and Central Prison in Rangpur (see Sec. 4.7)	Joint G2G project: Law and Justice Division (MoLJPA) & GIZ (German Govt.); 1 Mar 2024–31 Dec 2026 (extended to Mar 2027); Budget: BDT 1,82,25,931

The Access to Justice for Women (A2J for Women) project sits in the social empowerment area as a bilateral initiative with GIZ and the Law and Justice Division. RDRS provides formal legal aid, court-annexed mediation, and physical case management in Rangpur District. Its field workflow, case tracking, and physical court audit are examined in Chapter 4 (Section 4.7).

Microfinance (since 1991, now 29 districts, collateral-free loans plus savings/insurance/training, >92% women accounts) and agriculture/climate work (short-duration and flood-tolerant Aman, solar pumps, sack gardening, floating beds, pooled disaster fund for 17,986 households in Kurigram 2023–24) and social work (non-formal schools, health/nutrition, WASH, anti-child-marriage and GBV campaigns) run alongside humanitarian work in Cox's Bazar.

2.7 Microfinance Programme: Udayan, Unnoti and Savings

I am adding this detail because the org-profile reads flat without it. RDRS does not run one generic loan. It runs two main loans with different risk.

Udayan is group-based lending for newly enrolled members. Unnoti is individual lending for members who have moved past group liability. Both sit on compulsory savings. Every member puts in at least BDT 50 a week. The monthly floor is BDT 200 for Udayan and BDT 500 for Unnoti. Compulsory savings carries 6% profit.

On top of that there are two voluntary options. General Voluntary Savings takes deposits up to BDT 10,000 at 7% simple annual interest. The Monthly Savings Deposit Scheme (MSDS) is fixed-term: three years at 7% and five years at 7.5% at maturity.

Two targeted products came up in the policy files I reviewed:

Water Credit is a WASH-linked loan of BDT 10,000–100,000 for safe water and sanitary latrine installation. It runs in 93 branches across six districts: Dinajpur, Nilphamari, Thakurgaon, Panchagarh, Habiganj and Moulvibazar. The loan comes with technical help and hygiene training, not cash alone.

The Livelihood Restoration Loan (LRL), 2nd Phase, was a COVID-19 recovery loan of up to BDT 50,000. Terms on file: six-month grace, maximum 24-month tenure, 8% declining-balance service charge, repaid in 18 monthly installments. It targeted low-income households, farmers and micro-entrepreneurs hit by the pandemic who needed to restart an income-generating activity.

Why this matters for MIS: Udayan, Unnoti, Water Credit and LRL do not carry the same risk or the same check. That difference is what the monitoring checklist in Chapter 4 is built around. Figures here are from internal policy documents and my placement notes; I would re-check thresholds against the originals before audit use.

CHAPTER 3

Literature Review

3.1 Management Information Systems

Laudon and Laudon define MIS as the integrated set of people, processes and technology that collects, processes and distributes information for decisions. For NGOs, the point is narrower: can a manager trust the number on the monthly sheet enough to act on it? That depends less on software brand and more on capture discipline, validation, and timeliness.

3.2 Project Monitoring

The OECD-DAC tradition treats monitoring as continuous tracking against indicators, distinct from episodic evaluation. A baseline fixes the pre-intervention reference; DQA checks validity, reliability, timeliness and precision during implementation. FGD/KII cover qualitative change; household surveys cover quantitative coverage.

3.3 MIS in NGO and Development Settings

Studies of MFI and development MIS converge on three lessons I saw at RDRS: (1) person-dependent reporting is a continuity risk — succession to formal systems matters; (2) last-mile capture (register vs. system) is where error enters; (3) monthly, staff-assigned schedules beat ad-hoc requests for completeness. KoBo-type mobile capture plus Excel/Power BI compilation is now the common low-cost stack, with integrated dashboards (e.g. G Banker) for microfinance portfolios (OTR, PAR, outstanding, write-offs).

CHAPTER 4

Analysis and Findings

This is the core chapter. It uses my daily log and the documents above as evidence.

4.1 MIS Tools and Systems Used in Project Monitoring

4.1.1 What the MEL Department actually uses

For regular reports MEL uses structured Excel formats and registers during routine visits. For one-off needs it uses KoBo Toolbox on mobile, which allows quick question changes and exports straight to Excel. In office the team compiles in Excel and uses Power BI for some dashboards. MEL outputs then feed into MIS for management decisions. MEL means Monitoring, Evaluation and Learning; Save the Children uses MEAL, where the extra A is Accountability to beneficiaries.

Table 4.1. Tool stack observed

Task	Tool	Why it fits
Routine capture	Excel formats + registers	Stable, auditable
Ad-hoc surveys	KoBo Toolbox (mobile)	Dynamic Qs, Excel export
Compilation	Excel	Branch-level joins
Dashboards	Power BI + G Banker	Visual follow-up

4.1.2 Baseline design learned through ICPS

ICPS is *Strengthening Disability-Inclusive Child Protection Systems to Prevent and Respond to Violence against Children with Disabilities in Selected Communities of Bangladesh.* Donor UNICEF. Period June 2026–December 2027. Budget BDT 2,20,40,834. Components Output 4.2 (social service systems) and Output 4.3 (harmful practices). Baseline was running in September 2026.

UNICEF gave 21 indicators: qualitative via FGD/KII, quantitative via household survey. Baseline means measuring the target group before start against those indicators. ESS is Environmental and Social Safeguard. TOR sets scope and method; the Inception Report confirms method and work plan before fieldwork. MEL maturity — how systematic M&E is — was a new phrase for me: more mature means more regular and evidence-based.

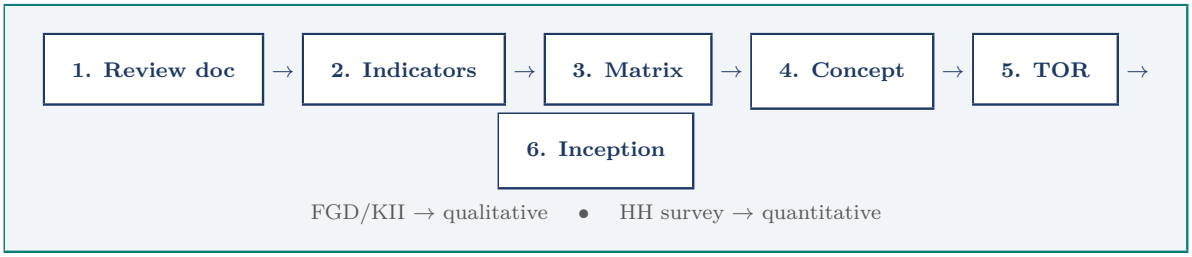


Figure 4.1. Baseline design in six steps as taught by Saiful Alam (ICPS at step 6, Sept 2026).

4.1.3 C-RANGPUR baseline instrument: KoBo questionnaire

The C-RANGPUR baseline household questionnaire is the indicator-measurement instrument for the project. The source document reviewed is the MEL Department file *Baseline_Questionnaires_of_CRANGPUR_-_Indicator_Result_Measerment.docx* (spelling as on file). The live tool is KoBo Toolbox (Enketo Express), hosted as an EU-region KoBo Enterprise instance at `https://ee-eu.kobotoolbox.org/x/wzjSgzZ6`. A plain fetch of that URL returns only the empty Enketo web-form shell; questions, skip logic and dropdown choice lists load dynamically at runtime, so live content including any Division/District/Upazila/Union lists requires opening the form in a browser with appropriate access. The interview opens as a baseline survey under the C-RANGPUR Project, described as voluntary, roughly 30–40 minutes, confidential and unpaid, with a Yes/No consent checkbox before proceeding.

The instrument comprises ten sections. Sections 5–9 map directly onto indicators 1.1–3.2; Sections 1–4 provide location, respondent and household controls; Section 10 is the scored vulnerability module.

Table 4.2: C-RANGPUR baseline questionnaire: section structure

#	Section	Coverage	Linked indicator(s)
1	Background Information (Location)	District, Upazila, Union/Pouroshava, Ward No., Village; location type multi-select: Peri-Urban, Char, Riverbank erosion-prone, Flood-prone, Waterlogging-prone, Drought-prone, Other	—
2	Respondent Identification	Name, sex, NID, age, mobile, ethnicity, religion, marital status, education, occupation, disability status/type, relationship to HH head, prior RDRS involvement (Federation / Microfinance Group / Development Projects)	—
3	Household Composition	HH head demographics; counts of children under 5, lactating mothers, pregnant women, elderly 60+, persons with disability	—
4	Assets, Infrastructure & Land Ownership	Dwelling ownership, homestead land, construction materials, electricity source, drinking water source, toilet facility, livestock/productive assets (14 categories), cultivated land by tenure type	Supports 1.2

#	Section	Coverage	Linked indicator(s)
5	Household Livelihoods & Income	Income sources (repeat group; 15-category livelihood code), IGA support received, CSA awareness/adoption/support (18 CSA practice types), income trend vs. 3 years ago	1.1, 1.2
6	Community Participation & Decision-Making	Membership across 21 community-institution types, meeting attendance frequency, voice/opinion expression, leadership roles, barriers to participation	2.1 (+ women variant)
7	Access to Social Services & Claims	14-category safety-net receipt, claims submitted/responded/resolved, response time, satisfaction	2.2
8	Access to Primary Health Care Services	Health-seeking behaviour, choice among 13 service-point types (incl. RDRS Eye Care Centre/Health Camp), barriers to access, health education topics received	3.1
9	Non-Communicable Diseases (NCD)	8 diagnosed-disease categories (incl. cataract, diabetic retinopathy), 15-category NCD screening/preventive services, awareness sessions, follow-up care, healthy-lifestyle practices, challenges	3.2
10	Household Climate Vulnerability Index (CVI)	16-item scored module across 3 domains (Exposure, Sensitivity, Adaptive Capacity)	HCVI composite

4.1.4 Indicator definitions and measurement formulas

Indicator numerators, denominators and formulas are reproduced exactly as specified in the source. All percentage indicators follow the form (Numerator ÷ Denominator) × 100.

Table 4.3: C-RANGPUR indicator definitions and measurement

Indicator	Definition	Numerator / Denominator	Formula
1.1	Targeted climate-affected HHs adopting ≥1 additional income-generating activity, +25% from baseline	Num: HHs with ≥1 additional IGA / Den: total targeted HHs surveyed	(Num ÷ Den) × 100
1.2	≥40% of targeted HHs increased income by 20% via Climate Smart Agriculture (CSA)	Num: HHs adopting ≥1 project-promoted CSA practice / Den: total targeted farming HHs surveyed	(Num ÷ Den) × 100
2.1	Disadvantaged people's active participation in community decision-making, +30% from baseline	Num: disadvantaged respondents who are institution members, attended meetings, expressed opinions, AND had opinions considered / Den: total disadvantaged respondents surveyed	(Num ÷ Den) × 100
2.1 (women)	Women actively participating in decision-making	Num: women meeting the above criteria / Den: total women respondents	(Num ÷ Den) × 100

Indicator	Definition	Numerator / Denominator	Formula
2.2	Claims successfully taken up/responded to by local authorities	Num: claims fully or partially resolved / Den: total claims submitted in reference period	(Num ÷ Den) × 100
3.1	25% of disadvantaged community members accessing primary health care	Num: respondents who sought care at CC / UH&FWC / UHC / FWV / CHCP / Den: respondents reporting a health care need in last 12 months	(Num ÷ Den) × 100
3.2	Reduction in NCD prevalence by 25% from baseline	Num: adults diagnosed with ≥1 selected NCD (hypertension, diabetes, heart disease, stroke, chronic respiratory disease) / Den: total adults surveyed	(Num ÷ Den) × 100

Claims in Section 7 carry five sub-measures as specified: claims submitted is the count answering "Yes" to submitting a claim; claims responded to is the count answering "Yes" to receiving a response; claims resolved is the count answering "fully" or "partially resolved"; response rate is (claims responded to ÷ total submitted) × 100; resolution rate is (claims resolved ÷ total submitted) × 100.

4.1.5 Household Climate Vulnerability Index (HCVI)

The Household Climate Vulnerability Index is the composite outcome measure built from Section 10 of the questionnaire (16 scored items across three domains). Its core logic is:

$$\text{Vulnerability} = \text{Exposure} + \text{Sensitivity} - \text{Adaptive Capacity} \tag{4.1}$$

The weighted scoring formula, with weights 30/30/40 exactly as specified, is:

$$\text{HCVI} = (\text{EI} \times 0.30) + (\text{SI} \times 0.30) + [(100 - \text{ACI}) \times 0.40] \tag{4.2}$$

where the three sub-indices are normalised as:

$$\text{EI} = (\text{Raw Exposure Score} \div 20) \times 100 \tag{4.3}$$

$$\text{SI} = (\text{Raw Sensitivity Score} \div 20) \times 100 \tag{4.4}$$

$$\text{ACI} = (\text{Raw Adaptive Capacity Score} \div 24) \times 100 \tag{4.5}$$

Domain A (Exposure, Q10.1–10.5, maximum 20) scores: (1) number of climate-related hazards affecting the HH in the last 3 years (0–4); (2) number of times the HH was affected by any climate hazard (0–4); (3) number of months per year typically affected (0–4); (4) number of temporary relocations/evacuations (0–4); (5) number of times hazards disrupted daily life (0–4). Domain B (Sensitivity, Q10.6–10.10, maximum 20) scores: (1) months of food shortage in the last 12 months (0–4); (2) duration of main livelihood disruption during the last disaster (0–4); (3) highest damage to house/crops/livestock/assets (0–4); (4) difficulty obtaining safe drinking water during the last hazard (0–4); (5) number of HH members needing additional support during hazards, covering children under 5, elderly 65+, pregnant/lactating women, persons with disability and chronically ill members (0–4). Domain C (Adaptive Capacity, Q10.11–10.16, maximum 24) scores: (1) frequency of receiving early warning information before a hazard (0–4); (2) number of disaster-preparedness measures adopted (0–4); (3) adoption of $\geq$1 CSA practice in the last 12 months (No = 0 / Yes = 4); (4) started or expanded $\geq$1 IGA to reduce climate risk (No = 0 / Yes = 4); (5) active participation in community institutions (0–4); (6) received preventive health services or adopted health practices for climate-related health risk (No = 0 / Yes = 4).

The full narrative interpretation text for each band is held in Section 10 of the source questionnaire and can be pulled verbatim for an appendix if required. Conceptually, Exposure and Sensitivity are largely external and structural, outside the direct control of RDRS or the household (a hazard-prone location cannot simply be changed), while Adaptive Capacity represents resilience: the dimension programming can influence and where project interventions concentrate. The framework was described in interview as interna-

Table 4.4. HCVI interpretation bands (as specified)

Score range	EI (Exposure)	SI (Sensitivity)	ACI (Adaptive Capacity)	HCVI (Vulnerability)
0–<20	Very Low Exposure	Very Low Sensitivity	Very Low Adaptive Capacity	Very Low Vulnerability
20–<40	Low Exposure	Low Sensitivity	Low Adaptive Capacity	Low Vulnerability
40–<60	Moderate Exposure	Moderate Sensitivity	Moderate Adaptive Capacity	Moderate Vulnerability
60–<80	High Exposure	High Sensitivity	High Adaptive Capacity	High Vulnerability
80–100	Very High Exposure	Very High Sensitivity	Very High Adaptive Capacity	Very High Vulnerability

tionally recognised rather than RDRS-original, consistent with the questionnaire's own reference list: IPCC (2022) *Climate Change 2022: Impacts, Adaptation and Vulnerability*; Hahn, Riederer and Foster (2009), the Livelihood Vulnerability Index, *Global Environmental Change*; FAO (2016), Resilience Index Measurement and Analysis II (RIMA-II); UNDP (2010), *Designing Climate Change Adaptation Initiatives: A UNDP Toolkit for Practitioners*; Brooks, Adger and Kelly (2005), *Global Environmental Change*; Sullivan and Meigh (2005), Climate Vulnerability Index, *Water Science and Technology*. Calculation is not fully automated in one tool; it runs across a combination of KoBo, Excel and Power BI, with the exact division of labour between them not fully specified (see Appendix verification notes).

4.1.6 MEL matrix and C-RANGPUR data pipeline

The MEL matrix is the monitoring planning tool. The file observed is *F01-112 Enclosure application monitoring matrix_E1_C-RANGPUR* (Excel/WPS), tab "Monitoring Planning". Each indicator carries the standard fields: indicator(s), indicator definition, data needed (quantitative plus qualitative plus disaggregation plus frequency), baseline value, location/source of information, methods/tools for data collection, and when to collect data.

An earlier design-meeting note additionally referenced start date, end date and numerator as matrix fields, consistent with that structure.

Table 4.5 shows the worked example for Indicator 1.1 as it appears in the matrix.

Table 4.5. MEL matrix worked example: Indicator 1.1

Field	Content
Indicator	Targeted climate-affected households adopting ≥1 additional IGA, +25% from baseline
Data needed (quant.)	Household ID; baseline and current IGAs; activity type; start date; income earned per activity
Data needed (qual.)	Reasons for adopting/not adopting; experience, challenges, learning, perceived benefits
Disaggregation	Sex and age of HH head, disability status, location, education level, vulnerability category
Location/source	Household
Method/tool	Structured questionnaire; Interview
Frequency (data-needed field)	Baseline, every six months, and annually (as written; clarification pending, see below)
When to collect (separate field)	Annually (end of each project year)

The matrix as observed lists both "every six months" and "annually" for the same indicator. Whether this reflects a data-collection versus reporting-frequency distinction or a drafting inconsistency is pending clarification and is not stated as a finding.

The internal planning notes behind this design are undated (the date field on the page was left blank) for a MEL matrix design session noted as "Climate Project → C-RANGPUR". Sampling appears as a discussion heading with no captured detail. Baseline questionnaire design considerations recorded are the type of data needed and target benchmarks (for example "increase one activity by 25%", matching Indicator 1.1). The Monitoring Officer role is recorded as responsible for data validation and field-level data collection. Persons with disabilities are flagged as needing a more deliberate, efficient data-collection approach; the exact method proposed is not fully legible in the notes. Data collection methods referenced are FGD and KII alongside the structured household questionnaire.

The pipeline in Figure 4.2 comes from the key informant interview with Md. Ajazul Haque, Manager (MEL). Table 4.6 summarises the five MIS questions and answers obtained.

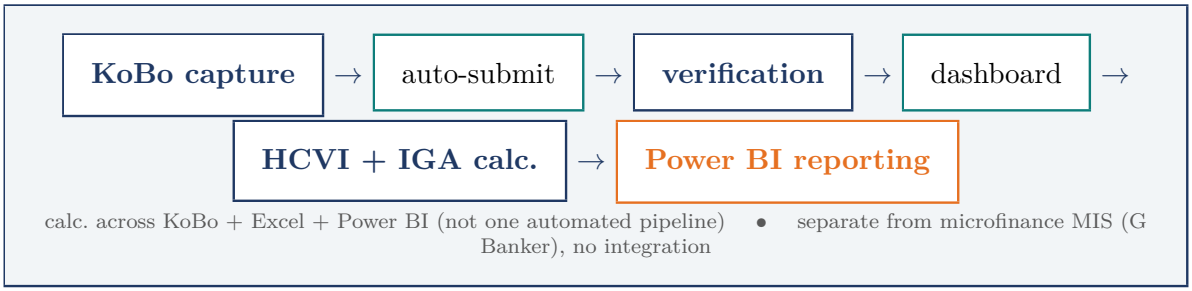


Figure 4.2. C-RANGPUR MIS pipeline as described in the MEL key informant interview.

Table 4.6. Key informant interview: Md. Ajazul Haque, Manager (MEL) – MIS answers

#	Question	Answer
1	Is HCVI calculation automatic?	No single automated tool; calculation runs across a combination of KoBo, Excel and Power BI
2	What is the "Code" column for?	Supports SPSS statistical analysis; numeric codes (for example 1 = Male, 2 = Female) are set up for that purpose
3	When a KoBo form is submitted, does data reach the dashboard automatically for verification?	Submission is auto-sent on completion, then passes through a verification step before appearing on the dashboard
4	How is the baseline compared to the end goal?	The baseline sets the reference/minimum value the end-of-project target is measured against; once set, monitoring proceeds against it as routine
5	Is the project MIS setup different from the microfinance MIS?	Confirmed as two separate systems: project M&E MIS (KoBo → HCVI/IGA indicators → Power BI) versus microfinance MIS (G Banker); no data integration between them

4.1.7 How microfinance MIS changed: Micro Bank to South Tech to G Banker

Mr. Iftekharul Islam traced this from 1995–97, when microfinance was starting and the field role was called ATM (Assistant Thana Manager). First software was Micro Bank, built with support from FAO and GTZ from Germany.[1] A team of 27 developers worked on it, including my grandfather (Boro Abbu) with a colleague noted as Mahabub. After that my grandfather ran most MIS reporting on Micro Bank himself, and RDRS leaned on him too much. One person holding that much reporting knowledge is risky for an organization that size. In 2011 RDRS brought in South Tech to reduce that dependence; my grandfather helped set it up, then retired. Around 2017–18 RDRS moved to G Banker, a Bangladeshi product — the current system with an integrated dashboard where routine branch reports come out with one click.

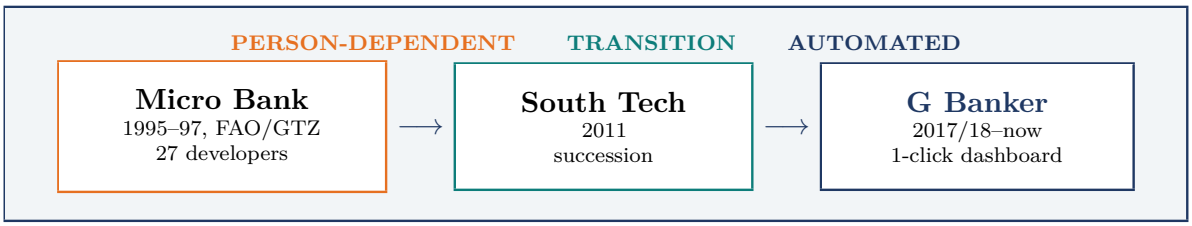


Figure 4.3. Microfinance MIS succession: the continuity lesson of this report.

I saw three outputs from G Banker. The Micro Finance Program Changes Report (CO-wise, Udayan office example) shows month-to-month change by CO: CO count, samity count, member balance, savings, loanee numbers, overdue, outstanding, OTR and PAR, profit/loss, disbursement and write-offs. POMIS-5 (Statement of Financial Position) is a branch balance sheet, this year vs. last year. POMIS-4 (Statement of Comprehensive Income and Expenditure) is a branch income statement, monthly and annual, straight from the system.

[1] My notes say "ZTZ"; that likely means GTZ.

4.2 Data Flow: From Field to Decision-Making

MEL staff go to sites, watch activities and collect data, then compile in Excel and Power BI for MIS and management use. The September 2026 monitoring schedule shows how this becomes monthly assignments in two parts.

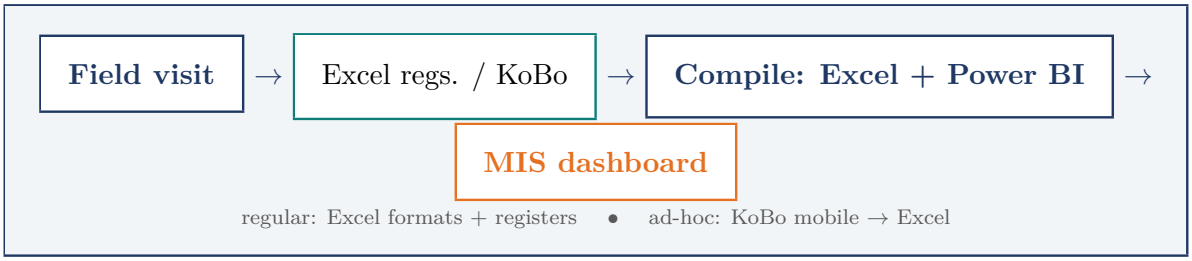


Figure 4.4. MEL to MIS flow as described by Fahmida Mostafa.

Microfinance part: ten repeat tasks, each assigned to one person and one branch, visited twice a month (02–15 and 16–28 Sept): group-level loan/savings verification, staff productivity, savings collection/refunds observation, loan disbursement papers, loan ceilings/overdue follow-up, write-off/rescheduled follow-up, audit/reconciliation, write-off study, misappropriation adjustments, pre-service training assessment.

Development part (that month): C-Rangpur baseline (Rangpur, Lalmonirhat, Kurigram, Sirajganj, Gaibandha, Jamalpur); MCGL DHIS2 validation in Panchagarh; Jononni DQA + ELCO/PW listing in Lalmonirhat/Rangpur; SEEDS economic-inclusion checks in Rangpur; ICPS baseline in Mymensingh/Rajshahi/Rangpur Division 06–24 Sept by Saiful Alam Sekul and Fahmida Mostafa (the live baseline Saiful explained to me); RERP post-distribution follow-up in Cox's Bazar; CALDRI beneficiary checks in Kurigram.

For C-RANGPUR specifically, the field-to-decision path follows KoBo capture with auto-submission, a verification step before dashboard display, HCVI and IGA indicator calculation across KoBo, Excel and Power BI, and Power BI reporting (Figure 4.2). The project M&E MIS is entirely separate from the microfinance MIS (G Banker), with no data integration between them.

4.3 Special Monitoring: What Gets Checked at Field Level

The MEL Department does not review portfolios ad-hoc. It works from a set checklist. I copied the headings from internal monitoring notes during placement.

Overdue cases are listed with amount plus a written reason for each. The reason feeds back into the next loan-committee decision. New loans are checked before they enter the normal cycle: what the committee approved against what was actually paid out. Field staff cross-check sanctioned amounts against field records with internal monitoring tools and review the supporting papers.

Loans above a set threshold get tracked on their own against two indicators: Portfolio-at-Risk (PAR) and Overdue-to-Total-Receivables (OTR). Fund misappropriation and forgery cases run on a separate track until resolved. A complaint box at branch feeds into a formal investigation procedure. Above the branch, Regional, District and Area Managers do scheduled site visits as a supervisory layer.

What struck me: the numbers for PAR and OTR come from G Banker, but most of the checks still need a person on site. The system flags. A person verifies. That split — where MIS stops and footwork starts — is where I think the analysis should focus.

4.4 Risk Control Linked to MIS: Credit Shield Insurance

Since July 2024 RDRS has run Credit Shield Insurance with Guardian Life Insurance Limited. Coverage is mandatory and covers two people: the borrower and their nominee. On death the family gets BDT 15,000 in immediate cash help plus a waiver of the outstanding loan (principal and service charge) up to BDT 20 lakh. Premium is BDT 6 per BDT 1,000 disbursed.

The claim path is fixed. The branch hears of a death. The Branch Focal verifies papers and forwards them. The Regional Focal reviews and forwards to the Central Focal at head office. The Central Focal sends verified documents to Guardian Life for decision. The decision comes back down the same chain to the branch, which must settle within five

working days of notification. Timelines on file: branch to report within two working days of confirming death; settled claims paid in monthly cycles; Guardian Life has 10 days to ask for missing documents.

At field level this is still paper and signatures. The software part is compiling and moving what field staff checked by hand. I include it because it shows MIS as carrier, not replacement.

4.5 Compliance Use of MIS: AML/CFT Data

The AML and CFT Policy (effective January 2022) asks for a kept database of everyone who controls or directs RDRS: board of trustees and executive committee members. The fields are fixed: full name, guardian's name, current and permanent address, date of birth, NID copy, TIN, other organizational affiliation, tenure on the board or team, photograph, and anything else the organization asks for. What counts as suspicious or unusual is defined by reference to the Money Laundering Prevention Act 2012 and the Anti-Terrorism (Amendment) Act 2012.

This is not credit monitoring. It is the same database skill used for a different job: reports to Bangladesh Bank and Bangladesh Financial Intelligence Unit. I keep it short because my topic is project monitoring, but it belongs if MIS is read broadly.

4.6 Loan Committee and Approval Hierarchy

Approvals run in tiers. The branch committee clears standard loans. Loans above set thresholds go up to area or regional level. That ladder is the same one monitoring walks back down: who signs off at the top is who checks afterward in field movement and high-value tracking. I note it here to link the product detail in Chapter 2 to the checklist above.

4.7 Project Case Study: Access to Justice for Women (A2J for Women)

To understand how RDRS handles monitoring and case-level data outside household surveys (like C-RANGPUR) and microfinance ledgers (G Banker), I attended a briefing and walkthrough with the Access to Justice for Women (A2J for Women) project team, subtitled Legal Assistance and Case Management [13]. During the session, I met with four staff members in the project room: the Project Focal, who has worked with RDRS for over 28 years across development projects; the District Project Officer; and two project paralegals. They walked me through their presentation slides and explained how case tracking and physical court audits operate on the ground in Rangpur.

4.7.1 Project profile, governance, and staffing

The A2J for Women project is a bilateral Government-to-Government (G2G) initiative between the Government of Bangladesh (the Law and Justice Division under the Ministry of Law, Justice and Parliamentary Affairs) and the German Government, with GIZ acting as the technical partner. Field briefings also noted linkages to the District Bar Legal Aid (DBLA) framework.

Originally scheduled to run from 1 March 2024 to 31 December 2026, the project is being extended to March 2027 with expected additional funding from the German government based on field progress. The total budget for the Rangpur component is BDT 1,82,25,931 (approx. BDT 1.82 crore).

Staffing has grown since the baseline slide was printed. The slide showed 10 staff members (4 female, 6 male), but the team confirmed that headcount expanded to handle the rising caseload by adding two support staff. The current staffing structure in Rangpur District comprises 1 Project Focal, 1 District Project Officer (DPO), 1 Finance and Admin Officer, 6 paralegals, and 3 support staff (expanded from 1). Counting these discussed roles yields 12 positions (6 paralegals + 1 DPO + 1 Finance + 3 support + 1 Focal), whereas a handwritten note on the slide marks the new total as 13. I flagged this 12 versus 13 headcount discrepancy for verification against the final HR sheet.

4.7.2 Core objectives and institutional split: formal vs. informal justice

The core objective is strengthening access to justice for poor and vulnerable people, especially women unable to afford private representation. The project operates through three functional areas. First, direct legal assistance: filing, legal counsel, and advice in coordination with the District Legal Aid Committee (DLAC) and the District Legal Aid Officer (DLAO), who holds the rank of a Senior Civil Judge. Second, gender-sensitive dispute resolution: resolving compoundable cases (*aposh-joggo* under the Code of Criminal Procedure, CrPC) through court-annexed alternative dispute resolution (ADR) and mediation outside prolonged trial loops. Third, case management: tracking justice seekers and under-trial prisoners from initial intake through to resolution.

In Rangpur District, project design splits formal and informal justice between two Partner NGOs (PNGOs), as summarised in Table 4.7.

Table 4.7. Institutional division of justice work in Rangpur District

Justice Stream	Responsible PNGO	Operational Scope & Venues
Formal Justice System	RDRS Bangladesh	Courts, District Legal Aid Office (DLAO), Police Stations, and Rangpur Central Prison (covering both criminal and civil cases)
Informal Justice System	Nijera Kori	Community Dispute Resolution (CDR) and restorative justice at community level

4.7.3 Service delivery and institutional achievements

RDRS places its paralegals directly into the formal court workflow. Project records through April 2025 show four concrete operational results.

First, direct assistance reach: the project assisted 6,092 justice seekers (3,348 female and 2,744 male) across the Rangpur courts and Rangpur Central Prison. Second, court-floor intake: paralegals and court staff jointly operate a Legal Service Information Desk (LSID) inside the Rangpur court premises, giving litigants a central point for procedural guidance, document routing, and daily intake logging. Third, multi-tier coordination: regular meetings connect the DLAC, Upazila Legal Aid Committees (UZLAC), and Union Parishad

Legal Aid Committees (UPLAC), alongside orientation sessions for court administrative staff and police officers. Fourth, formal judicial integration for ADR: on 18 March 2025, the Senior District and Sessions Judge of Rangpur issued an official Office Order publishing an approved panel of mediators for court-annexed mediation. Following this order, judges and magistrates routinely refer compoundable disputes directly to these panel mediators.

4.7.4 MIS and monitoring practice: physical court case audit

From an MIS perspective, the physical court audit is the most striking data-collection exercise the A2J team conducts. Because court registries in Rangpur are not connected to a central query system accessible to NGOs, paralegals physically counted active case files across every courtroom and clerk office in the district. They inspected both the *Ejlash* (courtroom bench dockets) and the *Serestha* (administrative clerk records and registers).

The April 2025 audit counted a grand total of 77,849 active cases in Rangpur District: 44,215 criminal cases (56.8%) and 33,634 civil cases (43.2%).

Caseload concentration differs sharply across benches: Among criminal courts, the heaviest caseload sits in the Nari O Shishu Nirjatan Daman Tribunal-1 (Women and Children Repression Prevention Tribunal-1) with 3,662 cases; the lowest sits in the Anti-Terrorism Tribunal with 9 cases. Among civil courts, the Land Survey Tribunal carries the highest load at 5,493 cases, while the Additional District and Sessions Judge-1 bench has 51 cases. Table 4.8 breaks down the criminal caseload by court tier.

4.7.5 Operational and data-collection challenges

The walkthrough highlighted two bottlenecks that directly affect monitoring and field delivery.

First, manual counting burden against staffing limits. Six paralegals must cover quality legal aid across four locations: the DLAO office, court custody holding areas, the LSID Help Desk, and Rangpur Central Prison. Simultaneously, this six-person team carries the task of physical docket counts across the *Ejlash* and *Serestha*. This matches the manual workload bottleneck seen in special microfinance monitoring (Section 4.3), where paper records require physical inspection because registries lack digital query endpoints.

Table 4.8. Criminal cases of Rangpur District: at a glance (April 2025 physical count)

Sl	Category	Court / Tribunal Sub-Category	Sub-total	Total
1	Magistracy	Judicial Magistracy (including files of respective GRO)	15,794	25,612
		Metropolitan Magistracy (including files of respective GRO)	9,818	
2	Sessions	District Sessions	8,936	11,339
		Metropolitan Sessions	2,403	
3	Tribunals	Nari O Shishu Nirjatan Daman Tribunals	6,068	7,264
		Others (ATT, CT, AHTT and ST)	1,196	
Total Criminal Cases				**44,215**

Second, institutional mindset. Working inside formal court structures requires continuous coordination. The team noted that the posture of some court officials toward indigent litigants and paralegal verification remains an obstacle, requiring sustained relationship-building and orientation rather than technical interventions alone.

4.8 Strengths of Current MIS Practices

One-click routine reporting from G Banker (CO-wise changes, POMIS-4, POMIS-5) saves branch time. A fixed monthly schedule with named staff, branches and dates makes follow-up clear. Using Excel for routine work and KoBo Toolbox for ad-hoc collection fits the task: stable formats where possible, flexible mobile forms where questions change. An integrated dashboard pulls data together for decisions.

4.9 Gaps and Challenges Observed

I read the May 2023 monitoring report on the Somriddhi Programme (PKSF) to see MEL output on paper. It covered Vojanpur and Debiduba unions in Panchagarh (since 2014) and Beruabari in Kurigram (since 2018), via questionnaires + FGDs with purposive/random sampling (2 of 3 unions that round) plus document review.

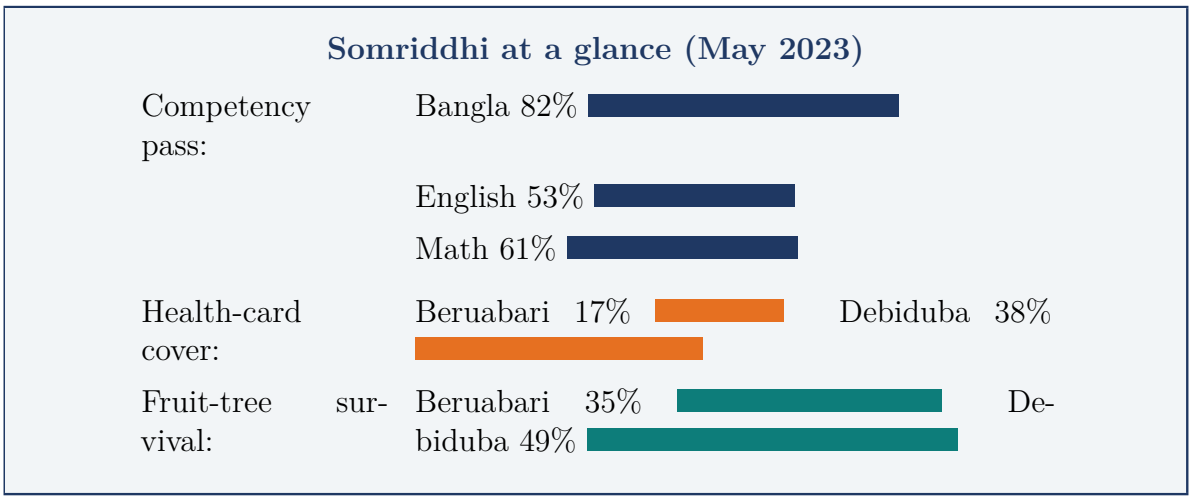


Figure 4.5. Somriddhi gaps as horizontal bars (no extra packages needed).

Education: 74 centres (34 Beruabari, 40 Debiduba; 1,926 students; 12 visited). MIS attendance did not match registers (Beruabari MIS 100% vs. 89% register). Pass: Bangla 82%, English 53%, Math 61%, wide centre variation. Turnover was the main problem: 11 of 74 centres changed teacher in four months; materials short, no play equipment, only 45% followed lesson plans.

Health: card coverage 17% (Beruabari) vs. 38% (Debiduba). Static + twice-weekly satellite clinics plus eye camps. Fees over four months: BDT 47,620 vs. BDT 91,660. FGDs broadly positive; requests: more satellites, lower card cost, steadier medicines.

Rehabilitation (2018–19 cohort, 4 + 8 beneficiaries, ~BDT 1 lakh assets each): Beruabari incomes mostly fell (most >70, no reinvestment route); Debiduba 60% rose. Follow-up patchy — 65% of income/expenditure records missing at visit. Housing (electricity, tube-well, sanitation) improved since baseline.

Homestead (25 + 20 homes; saplings, seeds, compost rings, fencing, poultry/pigeon houses, 2018–19): fruit-tree survival 35% vs. 49% (flood, late planting, weak stock). Vermicompost, eco-stoves, pheromone traps rarely in use.

Cross-cutting issue for my topic: MIS figures and field registers often did not match — the same data-integrity problem as loan-record matching, at programme level.

4.9.1 Instrument and documentation quality: C-RANGPUR observations

Three low-key inconsistencies surfaced in the C-RANGPUR source documents. They do not alter the data but are relevant evidence for an MIS-practices evaluation. First, the sub-heading before the Section 8 (health care) measurement matrix reads "Indicator 3.2 Measurement Matrix" while the matrix itself measures Indicator 3.1 (health care access); Indicator 3.2 (NCD reduction) is correctly introduced separately under Section 9, which points to a labelling slip in the source document rather than a data error. Second, the project name is spelled inconsistently in the codebook ("C RANGPU" at Q5.3.2 versus "C RANGPUR" at Q5.4.1), a minor data-entry and quality-assurance inconsistency. Third, several "select multiple" questions (for example livestock and productive assets, CSA practices, and disability type) appear as single answer-code lists in the Word export; in the live KoBo tool these typically export as one binary (0/1) column per option, so downstream Power BI processing needs to account for that structure correctly.

Implication: add the reconciliation check in Chapter 5 before any dashboard is trusted; include an instrument proofread and a KoBo-export-to-Power-BI mapping check for multi-select fields.

4.10 Sample Findings Table

Field evidence: interviews above; Sept 2026 schedule; G Banker outputs (Udayan, POMIS-5/4); Somriddhi May 2023 report.

4.11 Daily Log (kept live)

To provide full transparency and an empirical audit trail for this evaluation, Table 4.10 documents the chronological log of daily activities, key informant interviews, field document reviews, system audits, and methodological exercises completed during the internship placement at the RDRS MEL Department. It serves as the primary evidence repository supporting the analytical findings discussed throughout Chapter 4.

Table 4.9. Condensed findings

MIS practice / tool	Observation	Strength / gap
G Banker 1-click	CO-wise, POMIS-4/5	Strength: time, consistency
Monthly schedule	Staff × branch × date	Strength: accountability
Excel + KoBo	Routine vs. ad-hoc	Strength: fit-for-task
Register-to-MIS	100% vs. 89%; 65% missing	Gap: reconciliation
Follow-up	11/74 turnover; 35% vs. 49%	Gap: supervision
Special monitoring	Overdue reason, high-value PAR/OTR, document check	Strength: checklist; Gap: manual load
Credit Shield	Guardian Life since Jul 2024; BDT 6 per 1,000	Strength: clear chain; Gap: paper-heavy
C-RANGPUR KoBo pipeline	Auto-submit → verification → dashboard → Power BI; separate from G Banker	Strength: defined flow; Gap: HCVI calc. across 3 tools
C-RANGPUR instrument	10-section questionnaire; 7 indicators; HCVI 30/30/40; MEL matrix F01-112	Strength: traceable; Gap: label/code slips; freq. to confirm
Udayan/Unnoti + savings	BDT 50/wk; MSDS 3-yr 7%, 5-yr 7.5%	Context for risk
A2J court audit & case tracking	Physical file count in *Ejlash* & *Serestha* (77,849 cases, Apr 2025); 6,092 assisted (3,348 F / 2,744 M) via LSID & prison	Strength: granular baseline of court backlog; Gap: heavy manual counting load on 6 paralegals

Table 4.10: Comprehensive daily activity and fieldwork log

Date / Day	Activity / Focus	Contact / Source	Key observations & MIS learnings
01 Sep 2026 (Day 1)	Departmental induction; placement briefing; orientation on RDRS operational history and 6th Strategic Plan (2023–2027).	Head of MEL; Senior MEL Officer; RDRS Strategic Plan; Annual Report 2021–22	Mapped institutional scale: 406 Federations, 33 districts, 183 upazilas, 872 unions, 1.64M participants across 5 core thematic programme domains.
02 Sep 2026 (Day 2)	MEL departmental workflow walkthrough; review of data capture tools and field reporting channels.	Fahmida Mostafa (Senior MEL Officer)	Documented 3-tier data toolchain: physical registers and structured Excel formats for routine tasks; KoBo Toolbox on mobile for ad-hoc surveys; Power BI dashboards for central MIS.
03 Sep 2026 (Day 3)	Analysis of September 2026 departmental monitoring schedule; mapping microfinance vs development project allocations.	Fahmida Mostafa; MEL Monitoring Officers; Sept 2026 Schedule	Decoded 2-part schedule: 10 recurring microfinance branch tasks (bi-monthly visits: 02–15 Sept & 16–28 Sept) and 7 development project field monitoring assignments.
07 Sep 2026 (Day 4)	ICPS baseline survey walkthrough; technical briefing on indicator design and MEL maturity (~2 hours).	Md. Saiful Alam (Shekul) (ICPS baseline team; ex-MEAL & GIS, Save the Children)	Analyzed 6-step baseline design lifecycle; studied 21 UNICEF child protection indicators, method split (FGD/KII vs HH survey), and Environmental and Social Safeguards (ESS).

Date / Day	Activity / Focus	Contact / Source	Key observations & MIS learnings
09 Sep 2026 (Day 5)	Historical interview on microfinance MIS evolution from manual ledgers to contemporary automation.	Mr. Iftekharul Islam (Manager, Monitoring)	Traced 3 eras: Micro Bank (1995–97, FAO/GTZ, 27 developers incl. grandfather / Boro Abbu & Mahabub, single-person risk); South Tech (2011); G Banker (2017/18).
11 Sep 2026 (Day 6)	Audit of live G Banker system outputs; examination of automated branch financial statements and portfolio reports.	Iftekharul Islam; Udayan Branch Office system exports	Inspected 1-click generation of CO-wise Program Changes Report (CO count, samity count, savings, loanees, overdue, outstanding, OTR, PAR, write-offs); evaluated POMIS-4 and POMIS-5.
14 Sep 2026 (Day 7)	Detailed review of microfinance branch monitoring checklist and internal supervisory controls.	Field Monitoring Officers; Microfinance Monitoring Guidelines	Mapped 10 field inspection tasks: overdue borrower follow-up, loan ceilings vs disbursement, passbook-to-ledger audit reconciliation, staff productivity, and write-off adjustments.
16 Sep 2026 (Day 8)	Review of Credit Shield Insurance system, microinsurance claim workflows, and underwriting terms.	Microfinance Accounts & Operations Staff; Guardian Life Agreement	Evaluated dual-benefit structure (full loan waiver + BDT 5,000 funeral grant; premium BDT 6 per 1,000 principal); identified paper-dossier transmission bottleneck to Head Office.

Date / Day	Activity / Focus	Contact / Source	Key observations & MIS learnings
18 Sep 2026 (Day 9)	Review of AML/CFT compliance monitoring under BFIU guidelines and loan sanctioning hierarchy.	Compliance & Monitoring Officers; RDRS Credit Policy Manual	Mapped approval thresholds (CO recommendation → BM up to BDT 1.5L → AM up to BDT 3.0L → RM up to BDT 5.0L → HoM > 5.0L); checked BFIU cash reporting limits (≥ BDT 5.0L).
21 Sep 2026 (Day 10)	Structural codebook analysis of C-RANGPUR digital baseline household survey instrument.	MEL Technical Staff; KoBo Toolbox Questionnaire (Enketo instance)	Examined 10 questionnaire sections covering demographics, WASH, CSA adoption, NCDs, and disability; identified codebook typos ("C RANGPU") and multi-select flattening issues.
23 Sep 2026 (Day 11)	Key Informant Interview (KII) on C-RANGPUR MIS pipeline, indicator formulas, and vulnerability index automation.	Md. Ajazul Haque (Manager, MEL)	Analyzed Household Climate Vulnerability Index formula ($HCVI = 0.30EI + 0.30SI + 0.40[100 - ACI]$); confirmed KoBo → server → Excel → Power BI pipeline without G Banker integration.
28 Sep 2026 (Day 12)	Detailed review of C-RANGPUR project monitoring matrix file F01-112 ("Monitoring Planning" tab).	Md. Ajazul Haque; MEL Matrix Spreadsheet	Verified 7 project indicators (1.1–3.2), numerators, denominators, disaggregation dimensions (gender, disability, poverty band), reporting frequencies, and institutional data flows.

Date / Day	Activity / Focus	Contact / Source	Key observations & MIS learnings
05 Oct 2026 (Day 13)	Archival audit of Somriddhi Programme Field Monitoring Report (May 2023; Panchagarh & Kurigram).	MEL Archive; May 2023 Monitoring Report (PKSF-funded)	Identified critical last-mile discrepancies: education attendance mismatch (100% MIS vs 89% register); 11/74 teacher turnover; ultra-poor asset grants missing 65% expense records; low tree survival (35% vs 49%).
12 Oct 2026 (Day 14)	Comparative analysis of microfinance MIS architecture vs development project MEL toolchains.	Fahmida Mostafa; Iftekharul Islam	Mapped systemic divergence: G Banker is transaction-driven with a locked single-database source of truth; project MEL relies on decoupled mobile KoBo surveys and manual spreadsheet joins.
19 Oct 2026 (Day 15)	Access to Justice for Women (A2J for Women) project walkthrough and operational debriefing.	Project Focal (28+ yrs at RDRS); DPO; 2 Project Paralegals	Examined G2G MoLJPA–German GIZ bilateral setup (BDT 1.82 crore); mapped formal justice (RDRS: courts, DLAO, police, prison) vs informal justice (Nijera Kori: CDR); tracked 6,092 clients served.
26 Oct 2026 (Day 16)	Detailed data audit of physical court case docket records (Rangpur district court audit, April 2025).	DPO; Project Paralegals; Court Audit Registers	Analyzed 77,849 pending court cases manually enumerated across *Ejlash* (bench) and *Serestha* (clerk offices): 44,215 criminal (56.8%) vs 33,634 civil (43.2%); high workload on 6 paralegals.

Date / Day	Activity / Focus	Contact / Source	Key observations & MIS learnings
02 Nov 2026 (Day 17)	Field observation planning and methodology design for upcoming satellite eye clinic visit.	Fahmida Mostafa; Health Programme Staff	Developed observation checklist to track primary patient entries from paper clinic registers through KoBo mobile forms into monthly health MIS aggregations.
05 Nov 2026 (Day 18)	Synthesis of empirical findings and construction of condensed findings matrix (Table 4.9).	Self-directed analysis; MEL technical colleagues	Triangulated field evidence: identified that automated central dashboards mask peripheral register-level data gaps unless verified before monthly reporting locks.
08 Nov 2026 (Day 19)	Formulation and prioritization of actionable strategic recommendations for RDRS MEL practices.	Academic Supervisor Consultation; MEL Department Feedback	Formulated 3 core recommendations: mandatory register-to-MIS reconciliation sign-off, unified KoBo single-capture data entry, and institutional succession/dual ownership.
09 Nov 2026 (Day 20)	Verification, daily log finalization, cross-referencing of report sections, and document assembly.	Self-directed with complete repository materials	Finalized comprehensive daily activity log, updated abbreviations, checked LaTeX citations, and completed full report draft for academic submission.

CHAPTER 5

Recommendations

What follows comes straight from the gaps above. Each item names who does it and when, so it can go into the monthly schedule.

1. **Lock reports only after reconciliation.** Add a register-to-MIS check (attendance, savings, disbursement) to the monthly schedule; the checker signs before upload. Addresses the 100-vs-89 and missing-records gaps.
2. **Single capture in KoBo for ad-hoc work.** Keep Excel as compilation-only so field edits do not fork versions; export to Excel, never re-type.
3. **Protect continuity.** Document G Banker definitions (OTR, PAR, write-off) and keep two trained owners per report family, so no single-person dependency recurs.

If only one is done: do (1). The register-to-MIS sign-off fixes the most repeated error in this report.

CHAPTER 6

Conclusion

The internship showed me MIS as plumbing, not software: Excel, KoBo, Power BI and G Banker matter only because a monthly schedule, a register, and a checker make the number trustworthy.

RDRS has solved the harder half for microfinance through succession to an automated dashboard. The remaining work is the same everywhere — closing the last-mile gap between what the register says and what the system shows. Watching a live baseline (ICPS) and reading a closed monitoring round (Somriddhi) gave me both ends of that chain.

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APPENDIX A

Appendix

A.1 Interview guide (used)

Who reports what, when, on which form/app; who verifies; where stored; what breaks most often; what changed with G Banker/KoBo.

A.2 Glossary

General monitoring abbreviations (MEL, MEAL, ESS, TOR, FGD, KII, HH, IGA, KoBo Toolbox, PKSF, MFI, ATM, CO, OTR, PAR, DQA, A2J, GIZ, ADR, DLAO, LSID, PNGO, CDR, CrPC) appear in the abbreviations box.

Bangla and Court Administrative Terms: *Ejlash* is the open courtroom or judge's bench where formal hearings and trials take place. *Serestha* is the court clerk's administrative office where physical case dockets, cause lists, and registers are maintained. *Aposh-joggo* refers to compoundable offenses under the Code of Criminal Procedure (CrPC) that can lawfully be settled through mutual compromise, ADR, or court-annexed mediation between parties.

A.3 Next step

Field visit including an eye clinic to observe MEL data collection as direct observation.

A.4 C-RANGPUR sources and verification notes

Sources used for Sections 4.1.3–4.1.6: the MEL baseline questionnaire file, the F01-112 monitoring matrix ("Monitoring Planning" tab), undated internal planning-meeting notes, and the KII with Md. Ajazul Haque. The following items are pending verification and are not stated as findings in the chapters above:

1. Confirm Division/District/Upazila/Union coverage figures against proposal/logframe, matrix location fields, live KoBo choice lists, or GIS/MEAL staff.
2. Clarify 6-month versus annual frequency for Indicator 1.1 (collection versus reporting, or drafting inconsistency).
3. Confirm meanings of the "Monitoring vs. Supervision" and "PO → legal document → advocacy" meeting notes.
4. Confirm purpose of the blank "Code" column across questionnaire tables (working theory: office-side coding of "Other, specify" responses).
5. Confirm exact division of labour between KoBo, Excel and Power BI in the HCVI pipeline.
6. Follow up two unasked KII questions: whether the MEL matrix and live dataset synchronise automatically or need manual reconciliation, and whether/how indicators are selected or reused across reporting cycles.
7. Reconcile the planning-meeting "District → 6 total" note against coverage figures.

Candidate questions held for a follow-up conversation (with MEL/GIS staff) include: who designed the HCVI 30/30/40 weighting; whether the questionnaire is authored in the KoBo form builder or drafted in Word/Excel first; how skip patterns are implemented; whether a real-time submission-progress dashboard exists; how data quality is checked (validation rules, GPS/audio audits, back-checks, duplicate detection); who uses baseline results beyond donor reporting; whether midline/endline reuse the same households or a fresh sample; whether the F01-112 coding is used consistently; how mid-project matrix revisions reach the live KoBo form; and whether the required disaggregation is maintained in practice or simplified for reporting.

A.5 A2J for Women sources and verification notes

Sources used for Section 4.7 include the A2J presentation deck, court case audit records (April 2025), and the Office Order of the Senior District and Sessions Judge Rangpur (18 March 2025). The following items are pending verification:

1. Reconcile the 12 roles discussed in the room (6 paralegals, 1 DPO, 1 Finance/Admin, 3 support, 1 Focal) against the handwritten headcount note of 13 on the presentation slide with the official HR master list.

2. Confirm final formal sanction and revised budget allocations for the project extension to March 2027 from GIZ and the Law and Justice Division.

3. Cross-check the division of civil mediation cases between court-annexed panel mediators and the DLAO pre-case dispute mechanism.